



United States
Attorney's Office
District of Arizona



Georgia Man Sentenced to Over 4 Years in Prison for Fraud Targeting AHCCCS

Tuesday, September 16, 2025

For Immediate Release

U.S. Attorney's Office, District of Arizona

PHOENIX, Ariz. – Kenneth Terrell Harrison, 45, of College Park, Georgia was sentenced on Monday by United States District Judge Michael T. Liburdi to 52 months in prison, followed by three years of supervised release. Harrison was also ordered to pay restitution to the Arizona Health Care Cost Containment System ("AHCCCS") in the amount of \$6,538,485.09.

Harrison admitted that he owned an outpatient behavioral health counseling service, Aurtism, LLC, located in Mesa. Aurtism applied to be a medical provider for AHCCCS, Arizona's Medicaid agency, in 2019. At the time Aurtism applied to AHCCCS, Harrison admitted that he did not disclose his ownership interest in Aurtism to AHCCCS because he was worried that if he accurately described his involvement as the primary owner of the business, AHCCCS would deny the application based upon Harrison's prior criminal history.

Harrison further admitted that he engaged in a fraudulent billing practice targeting AHCCCS. Specifically, starting in January 2020, Harrison began obtaining AHCCCS identification numbers for AHCCCS enrollees, some of whom visited the Aurtism facility, while others he obtained fraudulently. Nearly all of the AHCCCS enrollees billed for by Harrison were members of the American Indian Health Plan ("AIHP"). Aurtism fraudulently billed AHCCCS for services that were never provided to the AHCCCS enrollees. Between January 2020 and October 2021, Aurtism fraudulently billed AHCCCS for \$6,538,485.09.

At the sentencing hearing, the Court noted the particular harm done to vulnerable populations in Arizona as a result of this type of fraud.

The FBI's Phoenix Division and IRS Criminal Investigation's Phoenix Field Office conducted the investigation in this case. Assistant U.S. Attorney Aron Ketchel, District of Arizona, Phoenix, handled the prosecution.

CASE NUMBER: CR-24-0393-MTL

RELEASE NUMBER: 2025-149_Harrison

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Contact

Public Affairs

Esther J. Winne

Telephone: (602) 514-7740

esther.winne@usdoj.gov

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HEALTHCARE FRAUD

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